PUPIL NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

YEAR 8 ENQUIRY • 1600–1783

The First British Empire (1600–1783)

Chartered Trade, Transatlantic Slavery, Maroon Resistance & The American Revolution



PRIMARY VISUAL EVIDENCE • CORPORATE IMPERIAL STATECRAFT — Nathaniel Dance-Holland (c. 1773)

Following the 1757 Battle of Plassey and the 1765 Treaty of Allahabad, the East India Company transitioned from a maritime trading outfit into a military ruler collecting taxes from 20 million Bengalis. Nathaniel Dance portrayed Robert Clive not as an administrator, but as an imperial general:

1. STANCE OF IMPERIAL AUTHORITY:
Clive stands resolute in scarlet regimental uniform, sword belt fastened, projecting military command over Indian sovereign territories.

2. THE BENGAL BATTLEFIELD:
In the background, sepoy infantry drill beneath smoke and battle pennants, symbolising the privatised corporate army that conquered Bengal.

3. ROYAL & CORPORATE HONOURS:
Embroidered badges of the Order of the Bath honour Clive's elevation to the peerage funded by astronomical private plunder ('jagirs').

4. THE OBSCURED REALITY:
The painting glorifies military prestige while obscuring the horrific 1770 Bengal famine where corporate grain speculation devastated millions.

SCARLET COAT	DRAWN SWORD	BENGAL PLAIN
Crown recognition of Company military conquest.	Armed force as foundation of trade monopoly.	Vast territorial wealth seized from Mughals.

DISCIPLINARY SIGNIFICANCE: In 18th-century imperial expansion, portraiture transformed private corporate commanders into national martial heroes to justify unprecedented chartered monopolies to Parliament.

DISCIPLINARY HINGE QUESTION: HISTORICAL EVALUATION
Does this portrait portray Clive as an honourable servant of the British nation, or does it disguise a reckless corporate plunderer whose greed destabilised an entire subcontinent?

Primary Visual Evidence: *Major-General Robert Clive, Baron Clive of Plassey* • Nathaniel Dance-Holland (c. 1773) — NATIONAL PORTRAIT GALLERY • LONDON

1. CHRONOLOGICAL SPINES [ENQUIRIES 1–5]
Structured chronological note-taking on each left page: 5 causal stages guiding pupil understanding as the teacher narrates the history.

2. DISCIPLINARY WRITING PRACTICE [4M, 8M, 12M]
Targeted extended writing on each right page: causal explanation, narrative account, difference, and constitutional evaluation.

3. CENTREFOLD TIMELINE & NOTES PORTFOLIO
Centrefold Living Timeline dual-coding sketchpads (pp. 8–9) and dedicated lined notes & essay planning pages (pp. 14–15).

COURSE SPECIFICATION • KEY ENQUIRY SEQUENCE	LEARNT	REVISED
Enquiry 1: The East India Company & Mughal Bengal (1600–1757) *How did a private chartered trading company seize sovereign military control of Bengal?*	☐	☐
Enquiry 2: The Transatlantic Slave Trade & The Middle Passage (1619–1788) *How did British merchants organise transatlantic human trafficking, and how was it endured?*	☐	☐
Enquiry 3: Plantation Reality, Queen Nanny & Maroon Resistance (1655–1740) *How did enslaved Africans actively resist colonial bondage in the Caribbean?*	☐	☐
Enquiry 4: The Thirteen Colonies, Proclamation & Boston Tea Party (1763–1773) *Why did imperial taxation drive American colonists from loyal British subjects to open rebellion?*	☐	☐
Enquiry 5: The American Revolution, 1776 & The Black Loyalists (1775–1783) *How did colonial rebellion dismantle the First British Empire and reshape global liberty?*	☐	☐

How did a private chartered trading company seize sovereign military control of Bengal?

Core Specification Focus: Royal Charter (1600); Mughal factory trading posts; Battle of Plassey (1757); Treaty of Allahabad & the Diwani (1765).

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • CORE CAUSAL NARRATIVE *Construct your causal explanation for each stage incorporating the core trigger terms*

1 1600–1615 • Why did Queen Elizabeth I grant a royal monopoly charter?

- 218 London Merchants
- Spices & Calico
- 300% Voyage Return

2 1615–1700 • How did the Company establish fortified coastal factories in India?

- Emperor Jahangir
- Surat, Madras, Calcutta
- Sepoy Regiments

3 1756 • Why did tensions erupt into crisis with Nawab Siraj ud-Daulah?

- Siraj ud-Daulah
- Fort William Seized
- 'Black Hole' Legend

4 June 1757 • How did Robert Clive achieve victory at the Battle of Plassey?

- Robert Clive
- Mir Jafar Bribed
- Monsoon Gunpowder

5 1765–1770 • How did the 1765 Diwani transform a company into a sovereign ruler?

- Shah Alam II
- Tax Rights (Diwani)
- 1770 Bengal Famine

In 1600, the East India Company had one clerk; by 1770, it commanded an army twice the size of Britain's.

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins]

EXTENDED WRITING PRACTICE

Explain why the East India Company was able to expand its territorial control across Bengal and India between 1600 and 1765. [12 marks]

Stimulus: **Royal charters granting trade monopolies and company private armies** | **The grant of the Diwani (1765) by Mughal Emperor Shah Alam II** *(You must also use information of your own)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES:

A primary cause of the East India Company's expansion was... • In particular, royal charters granted... • Furthermore, military victories such as the Battle of Plassey... • Crucially, the 1765 Diwani granted the Company... • Consequently, corporate merchants became...

KEY VOCABULARY BANK:

East India Company • Robert Clive • Battle of Plassey (1757) • Diwani (1765) • Shah Alam II • Bengal • private army • corporate monopoly • tax extraction

Task: *Using the vocabulary and connectives above, write your analytical response below:*

🎨 CENTREFOLD SKETCH CHALLENGES 1 & 2

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Milestone 1 (The Leadenhall Merchant Ship • 1600): Sketch an East Indiaman merchant sailing ship flying the company flag, laden with pepper sacks and cinnamon bales [⛵ tall ship • 📜 royal charter • 🌶️ spice sacks].

Milestone 2 (The Imperial Handoff • 1765): Sketch Mughal Emperor Shah Alam II on his raised dais handing the legal scroll of the Diwani to Robert Clive [👑 imperial throne • 📜 tax scroll • 💂 scarlet officer].

What were the economic mechanics and human horrors of the Triangular Trade?

Core Specification Focus: Triangular Trade; Middle Passage; Royal African Company; Zong massacre (1781); Brookes diagram (1788); Olaudah Equiano.

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • CORE CAUSAL NARRATIVE *Construct your causal explanation for each stage incorporating the core trigger terms*

1 1619–1672 • How did the Triangular Trade connect Britain, Africa, and the Americas?

• Manufactured Goods	
• Middle Passage	
• Sugar & Tobacco	

2 1672–1713 • How did royal monopolies and the Asiento expand British slaving?

• Royal African Co.	
• Branded "DY"	
• 1713 Asiento Treaty	

3 1713–1781 • What forensic conditions characterised the horrors of the Middle Passage?

• Tight Packing	
• Chained in Pairs	
• 12–15% Mortality	

4 1781 • How did the Zong massacre expose the dehumanising logic of chattel slavery?

• Captain Collingwood	
• 133 Thrown Overboard	
• Insurance Claim	

5 1788–1807 • How did the Brookes diagram and Equiano's voice ignite abolitionism?

• Brookes Plan (1788)	
• Olaudah Equiano	
• 1807 Abolition Act	

The slave ship Brookes carried 454 people under legal regulation—and 609 when unregulated.

Question 1: Describe Two Features [4 marks • 5 mins]

DISCIPLINARY DRILL

Describe two features of conditions endured by enslaved Africans during the Middle Passage. [4 marks]

Sentence Stems: Feature 1: One key feature was... • Detail: Specifically, on slave ships captives were... • Feature 2: A second key feature was... • Detail: This caused horrific suffering because...

Question 2: Explain One Consequence [4 marks • 5 mins]

STRUCTURED WRITING

Explain one consequence of the Zong massacre (1781) for the British abolitionist movement. [4 marks]

Focus on how Granville Sharp used court transcripts to shock the public and expose the legal classification of human beings as insured cargo.

Analytical Connectives: *A significant consequence was... • For instance, the legal battle in London... • This directly led to... • Consequently, public outrage...*
Sentence Stems: One consequence of the Zong massacre was... • Specifically, when Captain Collingwood threw 133 captives overboard... • This galvanised abolitionists because...
Key Terms: Zong massacre (1781) • Captain Collingwood • Granville Sharp • Gregson v Gilbert • human cargo • insurance fraud • abolitionist movement

CENTREFOLD SKETCH CHALLENGE 3

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Milestone 3 (The Forensic Ship Plan • 1788): Sketch the famous cross-section of the slave ship Brookes with lines of figures lying tightly packed on wooden shelves [architectural ruler • ship cross-section • iron leg shackles].

In 1781, British courts debated the Zong massacre not as mass murder, but as an unpaid insurance claim.

How did enslaved Africans actively resist colonial bondage in the Caribbean?

Core Specification Focus: Cromwell's conquest of Jamaica (1655); sugar cane monoculture; gang system; everyday resistance; Queen Nanny & Maroons (1739 Treaty).

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • CORE CAUSAL NARRATIVE *Construct your causal explanation for each stage incorporating the core trigger terms*

1 1655 · How did Cromwell's conquest of Jamaica birth the Maroon communities?

• Western Design	
• Spanish Enslaved Flee	
• Blue Mountains	

2 1670–1730 · Why was sugar cultivation described as an agro-industrial death machine?

• White Gold	
• The Gang System	
• Under 7-Yr Lifespan	

3 1680–1720 · How did enslaved labourers engage in daily sabotage and cultural survival?

• Breaking Tools	
• Slow Work Pace	
• Anansi Folklore & Songs	

4 1720–1734 · How did Queen Nanny lead the Windward Maroons to military victory?

• Queen Nanny	
• Guerrilla Warfare	
• Abeng Horn Signals	

5 1739–1740 · Why was the 1739 Peace Treaty both a triumph and a painful compromise?

• 1,500 Sovereign Acres	
• Tax Exemption	
• Return Runaway Clause	

Queen Nanny's warriors used tree branches as camouflage so well that redcoats thought the forest was attacking them.

Question 3(b) & 3(c): Contrasting Interpretations [8 marks • 10 mins]

HISTORIOGRAPHICAL ANALYSIS

INTERPRETATION 1 • PLANTER EDWARD LONG, HISTORY OF JAMAICA (1774)

"The plantation negroes are naturally indolent and require the perpetual surveillance and discipline of the driver's whip to extract labour. Without European mastery, order would instantly dissolve into ruin."

INTERPRETATION 2 • HISTORIAN HILARY BECKLES, CARIBBEAN FREEDOM (2004)

"Enslaved Africans waged an unrelenting war of resistance through daily sabotage, spiritual preservation, and armed guerrilla struggle. Queen Nanny proved that African military strategy could humble the British imperial army."

Explain how Interpretations 1 and 2 differ on the nature of enslaved African resistance. [4 marks]

Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 differ on the reality of plantation control. [4 marks]

Scaffolded Sentence Stems: Interpretations 1 and 2 differ on... • Interpretation 1 argues that enslaved people were... • In contrast, Interpretation 2 emphasizes... • One reason they differ is the author's perspective: Long was a slave-owning planter who wanted to justify..., whereas Beckles is a modern historian using...

CENTREFOLD SKETCH CHALLENGE 4

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Milestone 4 (The Abeng in the Blue Mountains • 1739): Sketch Queen Nanny of the Maroons on a high mountain crag sounding the curved cow-horn abeng, while camouflaged warriors observe advancing British soldiers [curved cow horn • leafy camouflage • rugged Blue Mountain peak].

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: CHARTERED TRADE, SLAVERY & RESISTANCE (1600–1740)

Living Timeline Dual-Coding Protocol: Complete each milestone sketchpad using dual-coding (combining visual storytelling symbols, causal arrows, and dates) to master the chronological spine across the centre-fold.

1600 • Foundation of the East India Company

Enquiry 1

Queen Elizabeth I grants a royal charter to 218 London merchants, establishing an exclusive trade monopoly over the Indian Ocean for spices, calico, and silk.

1619 • First Enslaved Africans Arrive in Virginia

Enquiry 2

A privateer ship lands around twenty captive Angolans at Point Comfort, Virginia, marking the beginning of hereditary chattel slavery in British North America.

1655 • Cromwell's Conquest of Jamaica

Enquiry 3

Oliver Cromwell's navy seizes Jamaica from Spain; Spanish enslaved people flee into the Blue Mountains to form free Maroon societies, while coastal plains become sugar factories.

1739 • Queen Nanny & The British-Maroon Treaty

Enquiry 3

Following decades of mountain guerrilla warfare, Governor Trelawny signs a treaty granting 1,500 sovereign acres and self-government to the Jamaican Maroons.

Centrefold timeline: Dual-coding sketches and dates turns narrative history into permanent long-term memory.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: PLASSEY, THE BOSTON TEA PARTY & REVOLUTION (1757–1783)

Living Timeline Dual-Coding Protocol: Complete each milestone sketchpad using dual-coding (combining visual storytelling symbols, causal arrows, and dates) to master the chronological spine across the centre-fold.

1757–1765 • Battle of Plassey & The Diwani Treaty

Enquiry 1

Robert Clive defeats Siraj ud-Daulah at Plassey; Emperor Shah Alam II grants the Diwani, handing sovereign tax-raising powers over 20 million Bengalis to a private company.

1770 • The Boston Massacre

Enquiry 4

British redcoats fire into an angry mob outside Boston Custom House, killing five civilians; Paul Revere's incendiary propaganda engraving unites colonial resistance.

1773 • The Boston Tea Party

Enquiry 4

Sons of Liberty disguised as Mohawks dump 342 chests of British East India Company tea (£1.5m) into Boston Harbour, triggering the punitive Coercive Acts.

1776–1783 • The 1776 Declaration & The Black Loyalists

Enquiry 5

Jefferson proclaims unalienable rights; Lord Dunmore frees thousands of Black Loyalists; following Yorktown, Britain signs the 1783 Treaty of Paris, ending the First Empire.

Why did imperial taxation drive American colonists from loyal British subjects to open rebellion?

Core Specification Focus: Seven Years' War debt; Proclamation Line of 1763; Stamp Act (1765); Boston Massacre (1770); Tea Act & Boston Tea Party (1773).

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • CORE CAUSAL NARRATIVE *Construct your causal explanation for each stage incorporating the core trigger terms*

1 1763 • Why did British victory in the Seven Years' War create imperial conflict?

• £133m War Debt	
• Grenville Taxes	
• 1763 Proclamation Line	

2 1765–1766 • Why did the Stamp Act provoke the cry "No taxation without representation"?

• Embossed Stamps	
• Sons of Liberty	
• Boycotts & Repeal	

3 March 1770 • How was the Boston Massacre transformed into revolutionary propaganda?

• Custom House Clash	
• Crispus Attucks Dies	
• Paul Revere's Print	

4 May 1773 • Why did the 1773 Tea Act provoke outrage even though it lowered tea prices?

• East India Co. Bailout	
• 18m lbs Surplus Tea	
• Monopoly Threat	

5 Dec 1773 • How did the Boston Tea Party shatter relations between Britain and America?

• Mohawk Disguises	
• 342 Chests (£1.5m)	
• 1774 Coercive Acts	

Colonists were so careful during the Boston Tea Party that they swept the deck clean and replaced a broken padlock.

Question 2: Narrative Account [8 marks • 10 mins]

DISCIPLINARY DRILL

Write a narrative account analysing the key events leading from the Stamp Act (1765) to the Boston Tea Party (1773). [8 marks]

Connectives: The crisis began in 1765 when... • This led to immediate outrage because... • Tensions escalated further in 1770 when... • The decisive catalyst occurred in 1773 when... • As a direct result...

Question 3: Explain Importance [8 marks • 10 mins]

STRUCTURED WRITING

Explain the importance of the Boston Tea Party (1773) for relations between Britain and the American colonies. [8 marks]

Analytical Connectives: *The Boston Tea Party was of critical importance because... • In particular, it provoked King George III to... • Crucially, the Coercive Acts united... • Consequently, peaceful reconciliation became...*

Key Terms: Boston Tea Party • King George III • Coercive Acts (Intolerable Acts) • Boston Harbour • General Gage • Continental Congress

🎨 CENTREFOLD SKETCH CHALLENGES 5 & 6

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Milestone 5 (The Stamp Act Effigy • 1765): Sketch Boston colonists hanging a straw dummy of the royal stamp tax collector from the Liberty Tree with a banner reading 'No Taxation Without Representation!' [🌳 Liberty Tree • 🪡 hanging effigy • 📜 protest banner].

Milestone 6 (The Boston Tea Splash • 1773): Sketch Sons of Liberty in Mohawk headdresses breaking open a wooden tea crate with a tomahawk and spilling leaves into the icy water of Griffin's Wharf [🪓 tomahawk axe • 📦 tea crate • 🌊 splashing harbour].

King George III called the Tea Party 'flagrant rebellion'; American patriots called it defending English liberties.

How did the ideals of the 1776 Revolution contrast with the reality of slavery and imperial defeat?

Core Specification Focus: Lexington & Concord (1775); Declaration of Independence (1776); Lord Dunmore's Proclamation; Battle of Yorktown (1781); Black Loyalists & Treaty of Paris (1783).

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • CORE CAUSAL NARRATIVE *Construct your causal explanation for each stage incorporating the core trigger terms*

1 1775 • How did Lexington, Concord, and Dunmore's Proclamation start the war?

• Shot Heard Round World	
• George Washington	
• Dunmore's Proclamation	

2 July 1776 • What central moral paradox lay at the heart of the 1776 Declaration?

• Thomas Jefferson	
• 'All Men Created Equal'	
• 41/56 Slaveholders	

3 1777–1780 • How did Saratoga and the French alliance turn the rebellion into a global war?

• Saratoga Surrender	
• French & Spanish Fleet	
• Caribbean Diverted	

4 October 1781 • How did French naval power force General Cornwallis to surrender at Yorktown?

• Yorktown Peninsula	
• De Grasse Blockade	
• 'World Turned Upside Down'	

5 1783 • How did the Treaty of Paris and the Black Loyalists conclude the First Empire?

• Treaty of Paris (1783)	
• 3,000 Black Loyalists	
• Book of Negroes	

Thomas Jefferson wrote 'all men are created equal' while personally owning over 170 enslaved people.

Question 5: Evaluative Statement Essay [12 marks • 15 mins]

EXTENDED WRITING PRACTICE

'British defeat in the American Revolutionary War was caused primarily by French naval intervention rather than American military strength.' How far do you agree? [12 marks]

Stimulus: **The Battle of Saratoga and the French Alliance (1777–1778)** | **George Washington and the Continental Army at Valley Forge** *(You must also use information of your own)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES:

A compelling argument for French intervention being decisive is... • In particular, Admiral de Grasse's fleet... • On the other hand, American military resilience... • Crucially, without Washington holding the army together... • In conclusion, while American courage sustained the war, French intervention...

KEY VOCABULARY BANK:

George Washington • Continental Army • Saratoga (1777) • French Alliance • King Louis XVI • Admiral de Grasse • General Cornwallis • Siege of Yorktown (1781) • Treaty of Paris (1783)

Task: *Using the vocabulary and connectives above, write your analytical response below:*

CENTREFOLD SKETCH CHALLENGES 7 & 8

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Milestone 7 (The Liberty Quill • 1776): Sketch Thomas Jefferson writing the Declaration of Independence with an eagle quill, while an enslaved servant attends his inkwell [quill pen • Declaration parchment • unbroken slave shackle].

Milestone 8 (The Evacuation to Nova Scotia • 1783): Sketch a British naval frigate in New York harbour embarking Black Loyalist families carrying the Book of Negroes certificates of freedom [British frigate • Book of Negroes • dove of freedom].

When the British surrendered at Yorktown in 1781, their military band played 'The World Turned Upside Down'.

NOTES

Notes: Record key causal links, essay plans, and teacher feedback for this unit.

NOTES

KEY STAGE 3 HISTORY • PUPIL PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT RECORD

PUPIL NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TARGET KS3 LEVEL: _____

KEY STAGE 3 HISTORY ASSESSMENT PATHWAYS • LEVEL DESCRIPTORS & CRITERIA

YEAR 8 STANDARDS

EMERGING (1–2)	EMERGING+ (3)	EXPECTED (4–5)	EXPECTED+ (6–7)	GREATER DEPTH (8–9)
Recalls key historical narrative facts; describes basic imperial events using guided sentence starters.	Identifies reasons for events; begins to describe causes of colonial expansion, trade, and conflict with structured paragraphs.	Explains multiple causes & consequences; writes structured causal paragraphs using precise treaties, dates, and historical terms.	Analyses causal significance; evaluates competing historical interpretations and weighs counter-arguments with detailed evidence.	Sustained, nuanced evaluative judgement; synthesises global trade, human exploitation, and political revolution across the 1600–1783 period.
Focus: *Add dates & key vocabulary.*	***Focus:*** *Explain *why*, not just *what*.*	***Focus:*** *Compare relative importance.*	***Focus:*** *Sustained historical criteria.*	***Focus:*** *Nuanced historical judgement.*

DATE	ENQUIRY • ASSESSMENT FOCUS	KS3 LEVEL / EFFORT	TEACHER COMMENT / SPELLINGS
	Enquiry 1: The East India Company & Bengal Inference & Similarity: Company Rule & Plassey (1600–1765)		
	Enquiry 2: The Transatlantic Slave Trade Forensic Source Follow-Up & Middle Passage (1619–1788)		
	Enquiry 3: Plantation Reality & Maroons Historical Interpretations: Enslaved Resistance (1655–1740)		
	Enquiry 4: Thirteen Colonies & Boston Tea Party Narrative Account & Importance: Boston Tea Party (1763–1773)		
	Enquiry 5: American Revolution & Loyalists Evaluative Statement Essay: Revolutionary War (1775–1783)		
	Independent Study & Notes Portfolio Pages 14–15 Enquiry Notes, Reflection & Revision Tasks		
	Teacher-Designated Assessment Task Designated Key Enquiry Assessment (Teacher Selected)		

INTERACTIVE DIGITAL QUIZZING HUB • SCAN FOR INSTANT RETRIEVAL PRACTICE

ONLINE RECALL

ENQUIRY 1	ENQUIRY 2	ENQUIRY 3	ENQUIRY 4	ENQUIRY 5
Company & Bengal	Slave Trade	Maroons & Sugar	Boston Tea	Revolution 1776
SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ
Best Score: [/ 8]	Best Score: [/ 8]	Best Score: [/ 8]	Best Score: [/ 8]	Best Score: [/ 8]

From the shores of Bengal to the harbour of Boston, revision is the key to historical mastery. Scan to test your recall.